

IIT Ropar

Track[₹]mate

Your personal budgeting app



Team Member

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Team Name:

Fincom - IIT Ropar



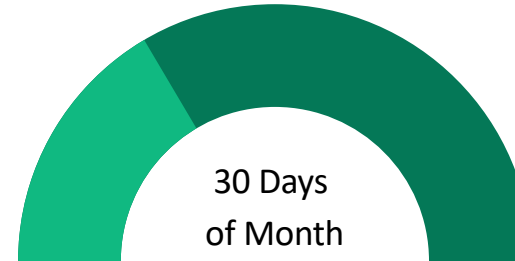
PROBLEM DEFINATION

CORE ISSUE

Students experience a recurring monthly "boom-and-bust" cycle due to sudden financial autonomy without the necessary capital management frameworks.

The "Boom" (Days 1-10):

A sudden inflow of cash creates a false sense of wealth. Students overspend on social outings, wants, and treats



The "Bust" (Days 11-30):

Funds dry up much faster than expected. This triggers mid-month panic and forces students to strictly cut back on essentials.

No Visibility ("Where did my money go?"):

Small, frequent expenses on things like coffee add up quickly. Without a simple way to track spending, students are often left wondering where their allowance went.



Constant Anxiety ("Am I overspending?"):

The fear of running out of money before the end of the month is a major source of stress. This leads to guilt over spending and an inability to plan for the future.



Paralyzing Complexity ("Existing apps are too much"):

Current financial tools are often built for salaried professionals, featuring complex jargon and features that are irrelevant and intimidating to a first-time user.



Unachievable Goals ("I want to save, but how?"):

Without a clear plan, important goals—like saving for a new gadget, a trip with friends, or an emergency fund—feel out of reach, leading to frustration.



User Personas



Aarav

The Anxious Achiever

Engineering Student at a Tier-1 Institution

Age

19 Years

Income Level:

₹15,000
(Fixed Parental Allowance)



Goals & Motivations

- Seeks social validation and peer acceptance through spending.
- Wants to eliminate the "mid-month panic" and end-of-month austerity.



Pain Points & Challenges

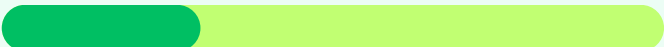
- Overwhelmed by "paralyzing complexity" in existing professional finance apps.
- Experiences high anxiety regarding invisible spending on small, frequent items like coffee.



Financial Literacy & Behavioral Indicators

Financial Literacy

reactive rather than proactive



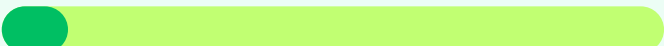
Social Friction

reactive rather than proactive



Spend Visibility

reactive rather than proactive



Priya

The Resourceful Striver

Final Year Student & Freelance Content Creator

Age

21 Years

Income Level:

₹12,000
(Variable: ₹5k Allowance + ₹7k Freelance)



Goals & Motivations

- Strong desire for absolute financial independence and self-reliance.
- Meticulously balances essential costs with long-term aspirations.



Pain Points & Challenges

- Standard apps fail to provide a cohesive view of variable cash flows.
- Logistical headaches managing shared expenses like rent with roommates.



Financial Literacy & Behavioral Indicators

Financial Literacy

manually tracks expenses in notebooks



Tool Friction

lacks digital tools aligned with student workflows



Saving Aptitude

Goal-oriented but hindered by irregular income streams



User Personas



Rohan

The Social Spender

Student & Active Club Member

Age

20 Years

Income Level:

₹10,000
(Fixed Parental Allowance)



Goals & Motivations

- Wants to facilitate social activities like group dinners and trips without friction.
- Aims to integrate social and personal finances for a total cash flow picture



Pain Points & Challenges

- Social awkwardness arising from "chasing friends for money".
- Single-purpose splitting apps create a disconnect in his personal budget.



Financial Literacy & Behavioral Indicators

Financial Literacy

understands bill splitting but lacks solo planning



Collaborative Spend

primary transactions are group-based



Network Effect Potential

likely to invite friends to use shared features



Ishaan

The Forgetful Fragmenter

Engineering Student (Hostel Resident).

Age

20 Years

Income Level:

₹5,000
(Fixed Parental Allowance)



Goals & Motivations

- Wants a frictionless way to log small cash transactions (chai, auto-rickshaws) before he forgets them.
- Aims to see a "Simple Dashboard" that summarizes his "Budget Health"



Pain Points & Challenges

- Frequently loses track of small, frequent cash expenses that "add up quickly".
- Manual Entry Friction: Often abandons tracking because the "core loop" of logging an expense takes too long.



Financial Literacy & Behavioral Indicators

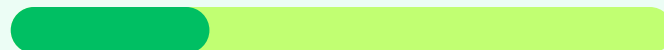
Financial Literacy

lacks a foundational understanding of budgeting



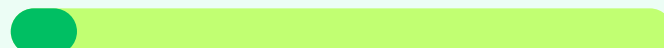
Tracking Habit

currently relies on "guesswork"



Categorization

needs "student-friendly categories"



KEY CHALLENGES FACED

The data reveals that student financial stress is not monolithic; it is a composite of behavioral, knowledge-based, and logistical challenges.



Psychological Challenges (Behavioral & Social)

- **Peer pressure spending (14.3%):** Students often spend to conform to social norms - outings, parties, gifts - leading to tension between personal finances and group expectations.
- **Overspending (7.5%):** Impulsive or unplanned purchases amplify stress and reduce discretionary funds.



Educational / Knowledge Gaps

- **No financial knowledge (14.3%):** Many students lack foundational understanding of budgeting, saving, and using financial tools.
- **Saving difficulties (14.3%):** Even motivated students struggle to save due to irregular income and lack of structured guidance.
- **Budgeting & emergency funds (7–7.5%):** Planning monthly expenses and preparing for unexpected costs remain weak points.

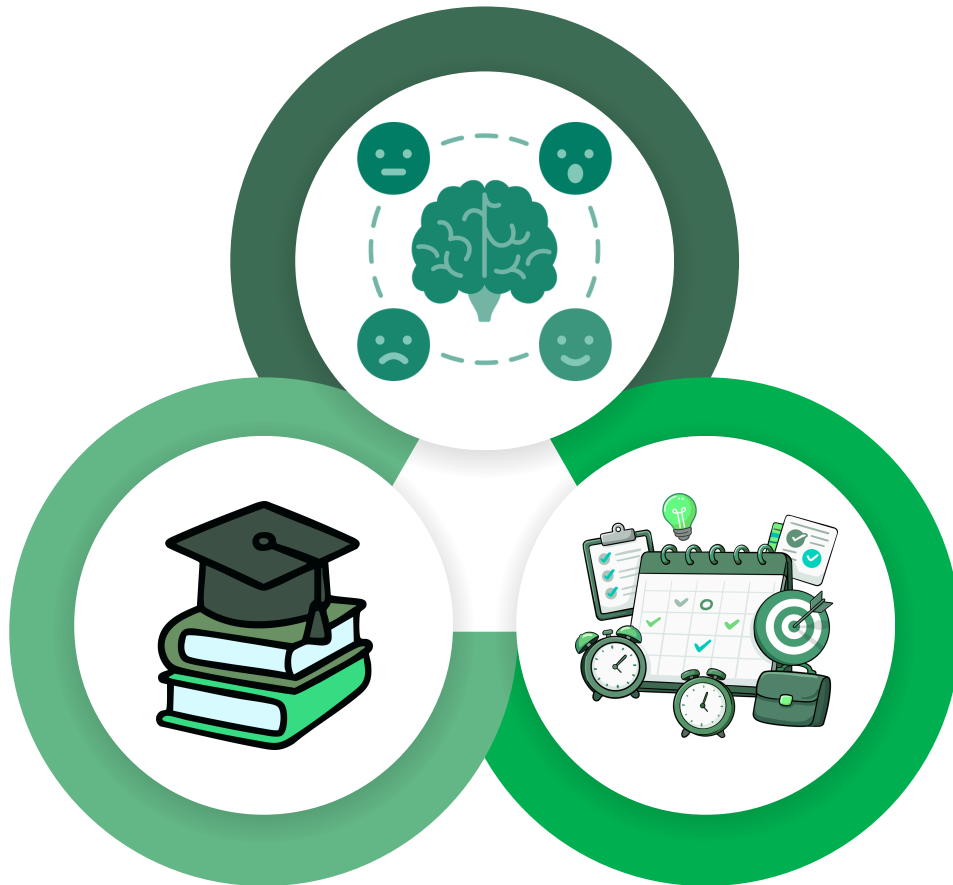


Logistical & Practical Challenges (Tools & Management)

- **Lack of tools (13%):** Existing apps do not align with student workflows for splitting bills, tracking spend, or managing irregular income.
- **Parental dependency & side income (13%):** Students rely on inconsistent allowances and sporadic earnings, creating unpredictable cashflows.
- **Loans & rent sharing (12.6%):** Debt management and shared expenses require coordination and create anxiety.
- **No bank account / tracking expenses (7–12.6%):** Limited access to digital payment channels and poor tracking ability further complicate financial management.

KEY CHALLENGES FACED

This triad points to a powerful intersection of psychological, educational, and practical hurdles. Students are not just struggling with the mechanics of money management; they are grappling with social pressures and a fundamental lack of financial literacy, which directly inhibits their ability to save.



WHY DOES THIS TRIAD (BEHAVIOR + EDUCATION + LOGISTICS) MATTER?

1

BEHAVIOR-FIRST UX:

Since peer pressure is primary, the UX must minimize social friction while promoting accountability (e.g., private nudges, group-safe defaults, optional visibility controls). Features that feel judgmental or that publicly shame users will backfire.

2

EDUCATION-IN-CONTEXT:

Financial lessons must be triggered by real events (e.g., after a large group expense, show “How to split without awkwardness” - 60–90 second micro-lessons). Avoid generic modules; embed lessons inside flows.

3

PRACTICAL FLEXIBILITY:

The product must support hybrid flows — manual entries, UPI links, scheduled transfers, and round-ups — to accommodate parental transfers, cash from gigs, and partial settlements.

COMPETITOR ANALYSIS

Competitor/Segment	Primary Purpose	Key Strength	Key Limitation for Students
	Digital banking & money insights	Auto expense tracking, bank integration	Too many banking features; not focused on student budgeting
	Credit card bill management	Rewards, credit score insights	Requires credit cards; target users are working professionals
	Group expense splitting	Very simple for trips & roommates	No personal budgeting or spending control
	Expense tracking	Automatic transaction categorization	Tracks spending but doesn't guide budgeting

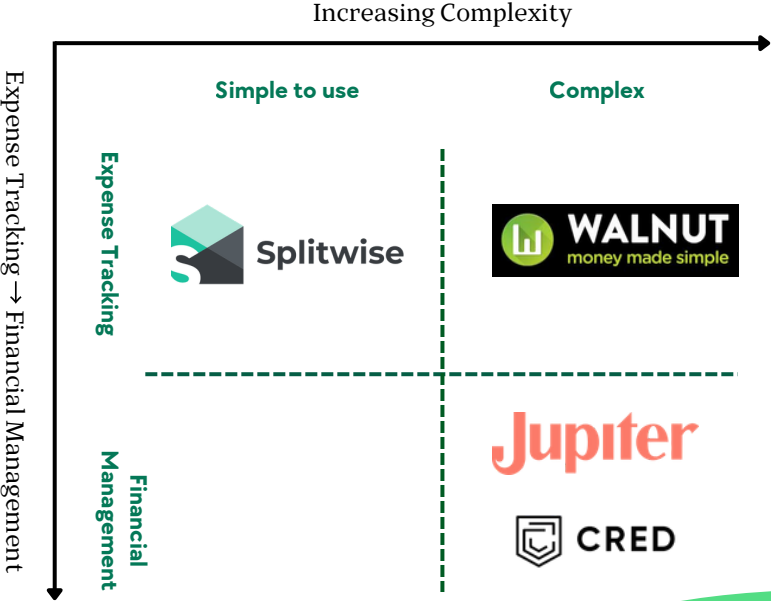
The landscape is divided, with no single platform truly owning the student demographic.

Key Observations:

- No Market Leader: No single financial app dominates the student market.
- Bifurcated Behavior: Students either use highly specialized, single-purpose apps or no financial apps at all.
- High Barrier to Entry: Comprehensive financial apps are perceived as too complex and irrelevant to students' lives.

Existing apps focus on either expense tracking or advanced financial ecosystems, leaving a gap for simple financial management tools tailored to students.

There's a clear demand for a simple, intuitive, and student-centric financial tool.



TAM :

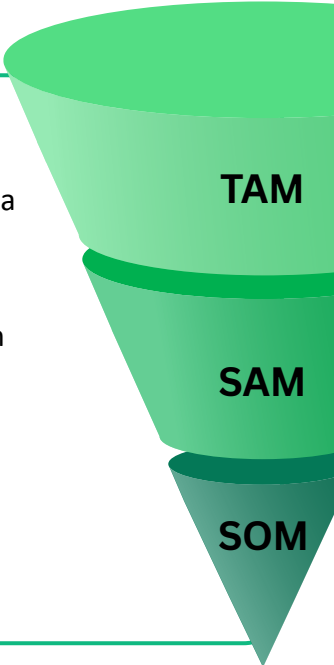
- 43M higher education students in India;
₹2,150 Cr revenue potential (₹500 ARPU via affiliates/premium features)

SAM :

- 25.8M digital-first students (60% of TAM) in Tier 1/2 cities with active UPI accounts;
₹1,290 Cr opportunity .

SOM :

- 1M students in top 500 colleges (IITs/IIMs) targeted via Campus Ambassadors;
₹50 Cr realistic 2-year capture.



Core Expense Management

- Manual Tracking: Log cash, UPI, and card spend.
- Student Categories: Food, Stationery, and Travel.
- SMS Sync (Future): Auto-populate from bank alerts.



Smart Budgeting & Planning

- Smart Creation: Onboarding-based 50/30/20 templates.
- Custom Limits: Adjust based on actual allowance.
- Visual Alerts: Indicators for over/underspending.



Saving & Goal Management

- Savings "Pots": Dedicated funds for trips or gadgets.
- Visual Progress: Percentage bars for small-step wins.
- Investments (Future): Integration with Mutual Funds/RDs.



Financial Literacy

- Contextual Nudges: Tips triggered by user behavior.
- Behavioral Advice: Guidance on over spending /saving.
- Bite-sized Learning: Education via real-time actions.



Expense Sharing

- Bill Splitting: Easy splitting with roommates /friends.
- Group Budgeting: Track shared rent and groceries.
- Payment Links: Quick reminders for group debts.



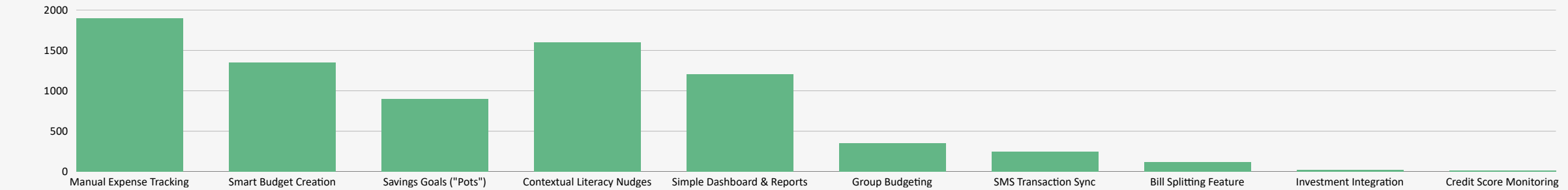
Advanced Financial Health

- Credit Monitoring: Display and improve credit scores.
- Financial Insight: Suggestions for long-term health
- Professional Tools: Bridging the gap to adult finance.



RICE PRIORITIZATION

Feature	Reach (Users/Qtr)	Impact (0.5-3)	Confidence (%)	Effort (Person-Months)	RICE Score	MVP Scope
Manual Expense Tracking	1,000	3	95%	1.5	1900	In
Smart Budget Creation	1000	3	90%	2	1350	In
Savings Goals ("Pots")	800	2.5	90%	2	900	In
Simple Dashboard & Reports	1000	2	90%	1.5	1200	In
Contextual Literacy Nudges	1000	2	80%	1	1600	In
Group Budgeting	600	2.5	70%	3	350	Out
SMS Transaction Sync	700	2	70%	4	245	Out
Bill Splitting Feature	500	1	80%	3.5	114	Out
Investment Integration	200	1	60%	5	24	Out
Credit Score Monitoring	150	0.5	70%	4	13	Out



RICE PRIORITIZATION

Based on the **RICE analysis**, the Trackomate MVP will include the following five core features:



Manual Expense Tracking

Quick interface to log cash/UPI spends with student-friendly categories (e.g., chai, stationery, outings).



Savings Pots

Visual goal-based savings (e.g., Goa trip, new phone) with progress tracking for motivation.



Simple Dashboard

Clean visuals for budget, category spends, and savings progress, clarity over complexity.



Smart Budgeting

Auto-suggests a budget from monthly allowance (e.g., 50/30/20 split), customizable for each user.



Contextual Nudges

Bite-sized, friendly tips (e.g., if overspending on outings → “Ways to have fun on a budget”).

Lean Feature Set: Excludes heavy features (SMS sync, bill splitting, investments) to stay focused on tracking, budgeting, saving. Features like automated SMS sync, bill splitting, and investments are deliberately excluded. While valuable, they introduce significant technical complexity (Effort) and are not essential to solving the primary problems of budgeting and saving for the initial user base.

Traditional E-Commerce Journey



TRACKOMATE: THE NEW ERA OF BUDGETING

9

Monthly Budget

Needs (50%)
Food, rent, essentials

₹0 / ₹4,000
₹4,000 left

0% used

Wants (30%)
Entertainment, outings

₹0 / ₹2,400
₹2,400 left

0% used

Savings (20%)
For your goals

₹0 / ₹1,600
₹1,600 left

0% saved

Budget Health

Great!

Savings Goals

New Laptop
₹12,000 / ₹50,000
24%
₹38,000 to go

Add Money

Goa Trip
₹8,500 / ₹15,000
57%
₹6,500 to go

Add Money

Add Expense

Amount *

₹ 0

Category Type *

Needs 50%

Wants 30%

Savings 20%

What did you spend on? *

Chai & Snacks

Outings/Friends

Shopping

Entertainment

1 Dashboard

Here, Students can see how much they spend in different categories and can also customize it accordingly and also their goals.

2 Add Expense

It is how a student can add his/her expense by clicking on the add expense option and then add amount and type of expenditure.

3 Transaction History

It is a kind of a bank statement where you can find your previous transactions and it also specify the transaction type.

4 Goals

Here, you can access your goals, how much you have completed them and also has the option to add any other fund.

₹27,500
Total Saved

4
Active Goals

0
Completed

29%
Overall Progress

New Laptop
₹12,000 of ₹50,000
24% Complete
Monthly target: ₹8,000
₹38,000 left
5 months left

+₹100 +₹500 +₹1000

Goa Trip
₹8,500 of ₹15,000
57% Complete
Monthly target: ₹1,000
₹6,500 left
3 months left

+₹100 +₹500 +₹1000

Emergency Fund
₹5,000 of ₹20,000
25% Complete
Monthly target: ₹2,500
₹15,000 left
6 months left

+₹100 +₹500 +₹1000

Room Deposit
₹2,000 of ₹10,000
20% Complete
Monthly target: ₹2,000
₹8,000 left
4 months left

+₹100 +₹500 +₹1000

3 Portfolio

It is just same as the prtfolio where the student can see how mucy the spent, average spent and also the category on which they spent most.

4 Actual Spending

A student can access to different pie charts, bar graphs to check how much they spent on a particular item and how much is left.

7 Quick Add

There is an option of quick add also where you can add money in your savings in just one tap and can also set monthly goals.

This Month's Insights

Great Job!
You spent 12% less than last month

Watch Out
Transport costs increased by 15%

On Track
You're 77% through your budget with 8 days left

Budget vs Actual Spending

Transport
Spent: ₹800
Budget: ₹800
Usage: 100.0%

Food

Transport

Fun

Shopping

Spent

Budget

Using this app students can change and track their monthly spending goals.

This app helps students to limit their spent monthly and also help them to save money.

Most of the students find this app helpful as it contains all the helpful features.

Problem Definition

User research

Challenges

Competition

MVP

Prioritization

User Journey

Product Discovery

GTM

Roadmap

Success Metrics

Launch Insights

Phase 1
On-Ground Army

The cornerstone of our strategy is a Campus Ambassador Program. We will recruit influential and well-connected students at each pilot college to act as an on-ground army. They will conduct dorm-room demos and presentations, sharing their authentic experience to drive adoption through peer recommendations.

Phase 2
Digital Buzz

Our digital strategy focuses on authenticity and value, not hard-selling. We will create a high-energy presence on platforms where students spend their time, such as Instagram (with Reels on financial anxieties) and WhatsApp (with daily trivia and polls).

Phase 3
Launch Week Blitz

We will create a coordinated, high-energy launch week to maximize visibility and create a surge of initial downloads. This will include branded stalls in high-traffic areas, a "Financial Fitness Challenge" event series, and an exclusive referral drive to catalyze viral growth immediately.

Phase 4
Scale & Sustain

Once the initial 1,000 users are acquired, we will analyze data and consolidate feedback from the campus ambassadors. This will inform rapid product refinement and allow us to systematize successful tactics to begin regional expansion to other colleges.

Projected Daily User Acquisition

A Funnel Breakdown

Day 1: The Blitz (350 Users)

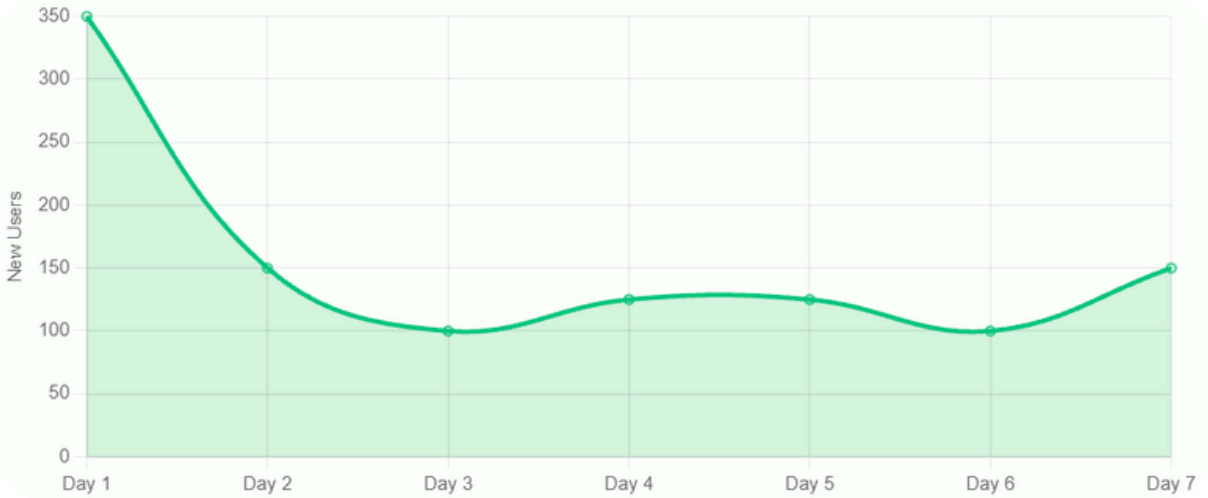
A sharp peak driven by on-campus stalls, partner collaborations, and viral referral drives.

Days 2–6: Stabilization

Natural decline followed by a steady plateau as the "On-Ground Army" and "Digital Buzz" become primary drivers.

Day 7: Final Push :

A slight uptick to meet goals, leveraging final on-campus events and referral incentives



A PHASED PRODUCT ROADMAP



Months 1-2
Launch & Stabilize

Goal:
Successfully deploy the MVP and establish a robust user feedback loop.

- Execution: Launch on Google Play Store across three pilot colleges
- Monitoring: Maintain an app crash rate below 1% and monitor server performance.
- Feedback: Conduct 20+ one-on-one interviews and manage student WhatsApp groups via campus ambassadors.

Months 1-2
Deepen Engagement

Goal:
Enhance core features based on Phase 1 data to reduce friction.

- Personalization: Introduce custom expense categories to meet diverse user needs.
- Logging Efficiency: Develop a "quick add" home screen widget to combat manual entry churn.
- Gamification: Upgrade "Savings Pots" with milestone tracking, specific nudges, and image support.

Months 1-2
Retention Driver

Goal:
Increase long-term stickiness and prepare for regional expansion.

- Group Budgeting: Enable shared budget pots for roommates, clubs, and trips.
- Viral Growth: Leverage social finances to create a "network effect" where users invite friends to the platform.
- Strategy: Conduct design sprints and backend scaling for a wider launch.



Success Metrics

Achieve >25% Weekly Active Users (WAU).

Achieve >40% feature adoption and a 10-15% lift in Day 7 retention.

Track K-factor (virality) and the total number of active shared pots.



Key Activities

Data Analysis, A/B Testing, Onboard refinement

Design Sprints, Backend Scaling, Marketing Planning

SUCCESS METRICS & KPIS

Primary Business Impact KPIs

>20%



Week 4 Retention Rate
This is the single most important indicator of product-market fit.

>75%



Activation Rate
The percentage of new downloads who complete onboarding AND log at least 3 expenses within their first 24 hours

>30%



DAU/MAU Stickiness Ratio
The ratio of Daily Active Users to Monthly Active Users

95%



Community Savings Momentum
The month-over-month (MoM) percentage growth of the total monetary value held across all users' Savings "Pots"

Secondary Success Indicators

+40

NPS Points

>4.6

App Store Rating

>35%

App Store Conversion Rate (>35%)

North Star Metric (NSM): Weekly Active Budgeters (WABs)

A user who performs at least two core actions within a 7-day period:

- 1) logs at least three transactions,
- (2) checks their main budget summary screen at least once.

Measurement Framework



Real-time

Conversion rates, engagement



Weekly

Adoption, feature usage



Monthly

Business impact, ROI

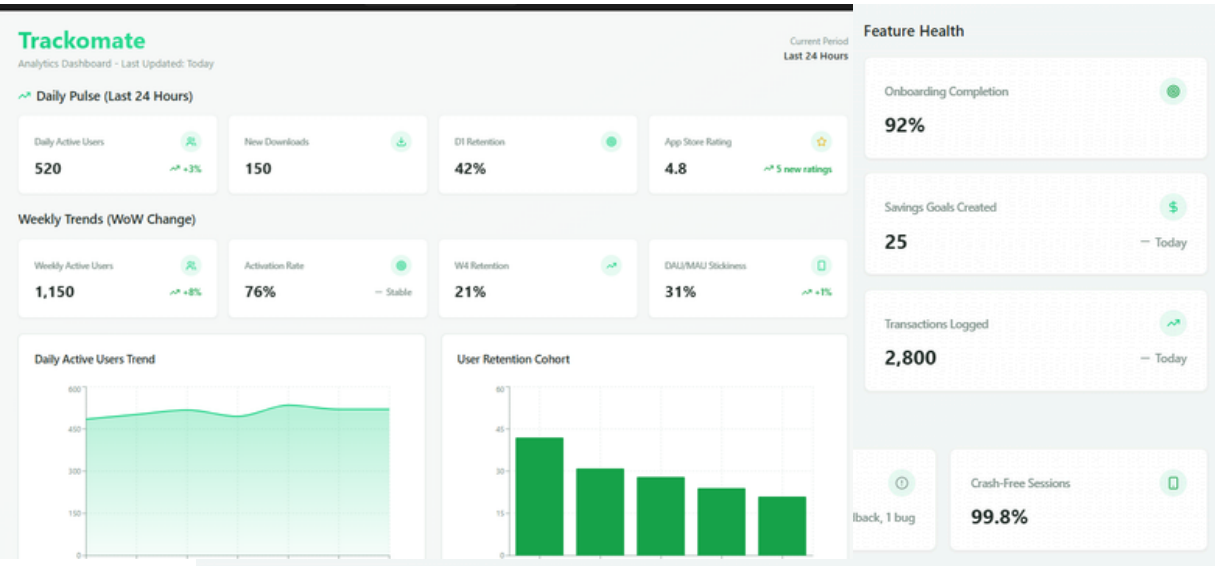


Quarterly

Strategy, roadmap adjustments

Problem Definition User research Challenges Competition MVP Prioritization User Journey Product Discovery GTM Roadmap Success Metrics

KPI Dashboard



Engagement Metrics

Breadth (How many users are engaged?): Daily Active Users (DAU), Weekly Active Users (WAU), Monthly Active Users (MAU)

Depth (How deeply are they engaged?):

Core Action Rate: Average number of expenses logged per user per week.

Feature Adoption Rate: Percentage of users who have used key features like Savings "Pots" and Reports.

Session Duration: The time spent in the app per session (Target: <90 seconds for efficiency).

Frequency (How often do they return?):

DAU/MAU Stickiness Ratio: Our primary measure of habit formation.

Sessions per User per Week: The number of times a user opens the app in a given week.

THANK YOU

● FOR YOUR NICE ATTENTION

